



GigLine
SAFETY & COMPLIANCE

2026 EDITION

The Triad OSHA Field Manual

What Piedmont Triad Manufacturers
Get Cited For — And How to Fix It

7 violations. Real findings. Plain language.
Written for the owner who is also
the safety officer.

Vince Lawrence

GigLine Safety & Compliance
U.S. Navy Veteran | 25+ Years Industry Experience
OSHA 30-Hour — Window & Rubber Industries
giglinecompliance.com | (336) 329-8899



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"Most small manufacturers in the Piedmont Triad don't have a compliance problem. They have a visibility problem. The hazards are there. Nobody has walked the floor and called them by name yet."

Introduction

Why This Manual Exists

I have walked a lot of floors in the Piedmont Triad. Manufacturing facilities, fabrication shops, warehouses, distribution centers, rubber and window operations. Small companies — 10 people, 30 people, 50 people — where the owner writes the checks, manages the production schedule, and is also the default safety officer.

What I find on almost every walk is not negligence. It is not indifference. It is the gap between what's required and what's known. The OSHA standards are not written in plain language. The penalty tables are not posted next to the equipment. And nobody is walking the floor looking for violations the way an inspector will.

This manual covers the seven violations I see most consistently in Triad manufacturing and warehouse operations. For each one, I have included the CFR citation, what it looks like on the floor, what I have personally observed, the penalty range, and the fix. Nothing generic. No filler.

The goal is simple: you read this, you walk your floor, you find the gaps before OSHA does. If you want someone to walk it with you, that's what GigLine does.

Proverbs 27:12 — "A prudent person foresees danger and takes precautions. The simpleton goes blindly on and suffers the consequences."

How to use this manual: Each finding section stands alone. You can read straight through or jump to the violations most relevant to your operation. The CFR citations are exact — you can look up any standard at [osha.gov](https://www.osha.gov) for the full regulatory text.

01 Machine Guarding

Machine guarding is OSHA's most cited manufacturing violation — and the one most likely to cost someone a hand before it costs the company a fine. The standard is straightforward: any machine part, function, or process that may cause injury must be guarded. In practice, that means point-of-operation guards, nip points, rotating parts, flying chips, and sparks all need to be addressed. The problem is that guards get removed for maintenance and never go back on. Or the original equipment never had adequate guarding to begin with.

CFR CITATION

29 CFR 1910.212 — General Machine Guarding

WHAT THIS MEANS ON THE FLOOR

Guards missing, removed, or bypassed on presses, grinders, conveyors, and cutting equipment. Point-of-operation hazards left exposed during normal production.

WHAT I SAW

Press line with the point-of-operation guard removed — operators running parts with hands in the danger zone. The guard had been taken off weeks earlier to clear a jam and never replaced. Nobody flagged it. Nobody stopped production.

PENALTY RANGE

\$16,131 per violation — up to \$161,323 per willful or repeat citation

THE FIX

Audit every machine on the floor. Replace or reinstall missing guards before the next shift. Create a lockout/tagout step that prevents equipment from running without guards in place. Document the inspection. Train operators to report missing guards — not work around them.

02 Lockout/Tagout (LOTO)

LOTO violations kill people. When equipment is being serviced or maintained, unexpected energization — electrical, hydraulic, pneumatic, mechanical — is one of the leading causes of workplace fatalities in manufacturing. OSHA requires a written energy control program, machine-specific procedures for every piece of equipment, and documented annual inspections of those procedures. Most small manufacturers have a generic LOTO policy buried in a binder. That does not meet the standard.

CFR CITATION

29 CFR 1910.147 — Control of Hazardous Energy

WHAT THIS MEANS ON THE FLOOR

No written LOTO program, no machine-specific procedures posted at equipment, no documented annual inspections, no employee training records.

WHAT I SAW

Facility with 12 pieces of powered equipment and one generic LOTO poster on the wall. No machine-specific procedures. Employees performing maintenance with power still energized — they said that's how it had always been done. Three of those employees couldn't describe what LOTO was.

PENALTY RANGE

\$16,131 per violation — frequently cited as willful at \$161,323

THE FIX

Write a facility-specific LOTO program. Develop individual energy control procedures for each machine — post them at the equipment, not in a binder. Train every affected employee. Document the training. Conduct and document an annual inspection of each procedure with a certified review. This is not optional and it is not a one-time fix.

03 Pinch Points & Unguarded Nip Points

Pinch points exist wherever two objects move together and at least one rotates. Conveyors, rollers, gear drives, chain drives, belt drives — all create nip points that can pull in fingers, hands, and clothing faster than a person can react. These are often overlooked because the machine is "running fine" and the hazard is not obvious until something goes wrong.

CFR CITATION

29 CFR 1910.212(a)(1) — *Point of Operation Guarding*

WHAT THIS MEANS ON THE FLOOR

Exposed nip points on conveyors, rollers, and drive components with no guarding or inadequate guarding that does not prevent contact.

WHAT I SAW

Conveyor system with exposed roller nip points at the feed end — no guard, no warning label. An operator's glove had caught and been pulled through six months earlier. The guard had never been installed. The near-miss was never recorded.

PENALTY RANGE

\$16,131 per violation

THE FIX

Identify every nip point, pinch point, and rotating part on the floor. Install OSHA-compliant guards — they must prevent employee contact, not just discourage it. If a guard cannot be installed on a particular machine, document the engineering review and implement administrative controls and PPE as a secondary measure.

04 Trip Hazards & Walking Surfaces

Slips, trips, and falls are the second leading cause of workplace injuries in manufacturing — and they are almost entirely preventable. OSHA's standard is basic: floors must be clean, dry, and free of hazards. Aisles and passageways must be kept clear. The challenge is that these conditions deteriorate gradually and employees stop seeing them.

CFR CITATION

29 CFR 1910.22 — General Housekeeping and Walking Surfaces

WHAT THIS MEANS ON THE FLOOR

Cords, hoses, and materials crossing walkways. Uneven or damaged flooring. Aisles blocked by equipment or inventory. No visual demarcation of walking paths in production areas.

WHAT I SAW

Extension cords running across main production aisle — taped down with duct tape, which is not a compliant fix. Pallet debris in marked egress path. Two floor drains with damaged grating creating a step hazard at a high-traffic crossing point.

PENALTY RANGE

\$16,131 per violation

THE FIX

Walk your facility with fresh eyes — or have someone walk it who did not build the layout. Mark aisle boundaries with floor tape or paint. Establish a daily housekeeping standard with assigned responsibility. Repair damaged flooring immediately. Eliminate extension cords as permanent wiring solutions.

05 Lockout/Tagout Procedures Not Posted

Having a LOTO program is not the same as having LOTO procedures that employees can actually use. The standard requires written procedures for each machine that has more than one energy source or where the shutdown sequence is not obvious. Those procedures must be accessible to the employees who use them — which means posted at or near the equipment, not in an office binder.

CFR CITATION

29 CFR 1910.147(c)(4) — *Energy Control Procedure Documentation*

WHAT THIS MEANS ON THE FLOOR

Machine-specific LOTO procedures exist in documentation but are not posted at the equipment. Employees servicing machines have no procedure to reference at the point of task.

WHAT I SAW

Facility with a written LOTO program in the safety office — three-ring binder, well organized. Zero procedures posted on the production floor. Maintenance technician performing a die change could not locate the procedure for that press. He was doing it from memory.

PENALTY RANGE

\$16,131 per violation — cited alongside the program deficiency

THE FIX

Print and laminate machine-specific procedures. Mount them at each piece of equipment — on the machine or on a nearby post within arm's reach of the lockout point. Update them any time the machine is modified. This is a 30-minute fix per machine that closes a citation that costs more than \$16,000.

06 Outdated Fire Extinguisher Inspections

Fire extinguisher compliance is one of the most straightforward items on an OSHA checklist — and one of the most commonly missed. The standard requires monthly visual inspections, annual maintenance inspections, and documentation of both. It also requires that extinguishers be accessible, unobstructed, and properly mounted. In practice, the tags go unsigned, the inspections get skipped, and nobody notices until an inspector pulls one off the wall.

CFR CITATION

29 CFR 1910.157(e) — *Portable Fire Extinguishers*

WHAT THIS MEANS ON THE FLOOR

Fire extinguisher inspection tags unsigned, out of date, or missing. No documentation of annual maintenance. Extinguishers blocked by equipment or inventory.

WHAT I SAW

Twelve extinguishers in a 40,000 sq ft facility — nine had tags with the last signed monthly inspection dated 14 months prior. Two were blocked by raw material stacked in front of them. One had a broken pressure gauge and had not been flagged for service.

PENALTY RANGE

\$16,131 per violation — multiple extinguishers means multiple citations

THE FIX

Assign one person to inspect all extinguishers on the first business day of every month. Sign and date the tag. Schedule annual third-party maintenance and keep the service records on file for three years. Remove any obstructions within 18 inches of each unit. This takes 20 minutes a month.

07 OSHA 300 Log & Recordkeeping Not Posted

Employers with 11 or more employees in most manufacturing industries are required to maintain OSHA injury and illness records and post the Form 300A annual summary from February 1 through April 30 every year — even if there were zero recordable incidents. The 300 log must be retained for five years. Failure to post or maintain these records is a paperwork violation that carries real penalties and signals to OSHA that your recordkeeping program deserves a closer look.

CFR CITATION

29 CFR 1904.32 — Annual Summary Posting Requirement

WHAT THIS MEANS ON THE FLOOR

OSHA Form 300A annual summary not posted during the required February–April window. Form 300 log not maintained, incomplete, or not retained for five years. Management signature missing from the 300A.

WHAT I SAW

February walkthrough at a 22-person fabrication shop — no 300A posted anywhere in the facility. Owner did not know the requirement existed. They had experienced two recordable injuries the prior year, neither of which had been logged.

PENALTY RANGE

\$16,131 per violation — failure to record and failure to post are separate citations

THE FIX

Set a calendar reminder: February 1, post the signed 300A in a visible location accessible to all employees. Maintain your Form 300 throughout the year — log every recordable injury or illness within seven days of learning about it. Retain all records for five years. If you have had injuries you did not record, address it now before an inspection forces the issue.

NC North Carolina State Plan

What Piedmont Triad Employers Must Know

North Carolina operates under a state OSHA plan approved by the federal government. That means the NC Department of Labor — not federal OSHA — has jurisdiction over most private-sector workplaces in the state. The NC OSH Division enforces standards that are at least as effective as federal OSHA, and in some areas more stringent. Understanding the difference matters for how you prepare.

Key NC State Plan Facts

Enforcement authority	NC DOL OSH Division — not US DOL OSHA. Inspections, citations, and penalties are issued by the state.
Penalty structure	NC aligns penalty amounts with federal OSHA adjustments. Serious violations: up to \$16,131 per violation. Willful or repeat: up to \$161,323. These figures are updated annually.
Statute of limitations	NC has a six-month statute of limitations from the date of the violation — not from the date of inspection. This matters if you have an ongoing condition; the clock may have already started.
Posting requirement	Every NC employer must post the NC OSH Job Safety and Health poster in a conspicuous location where employees can see it. Failure to post is a citation. The poster must be the current NC-specific version, not the federal version.
Required postings — full list	NC employers must also post: NC Wage and Hour Act notice, Workers' Compensation notice (if applicable), and any OSHA 300A Annual Summary during the February 1 – April 30 posting window.
Consultation available	NC DOL offers a free, confidential on-site consultation program for small employers. Participation does not trigger enforcement. This is separate from a GigLine engagement but worth knowing exists.

What I see most often in Triad facilities: federal OSHA posters instead of the NC-specific version, outdated 300A summaries left posted past April 30, and no documentation that the posting requirement was met at all. These are inexpensive citations that signal to an inspector that recordkeeping discipline is weak across the board.

Appendix A

Fire Extinguisher Monthly Inspection Log

Required by 29 CFR 1910.157(e)(1). Inspect each extinguisher on the first business day of every month. Sign and date the tag and this log. Retain records for one year minimum. Annual maintenance inspections must be performed by a qualified service provider — retain those records for life of the extinguisher.

Facility / Location: _____ Year: _____

Completed by: _____ Title: _____

Check Item	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Accessible & Unobstructed	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Gauge in Operable Range	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Pin & Tamper Seal Intact	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
No Visible Damage or Corrosion	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Label Legible	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Inspector Initials	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
PASS / FAIL	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—

Extinguisher Location Register

Unit #	Location / Description	Type	Size	Last Service Date	Next Due
—	—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—	—

Unit #	Location / Description	Type	Size	Last Service Date	Next Due
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

CFR 1910.157(e)(1) — Monthly visual inspections required. CFR 1910.157(e)(3) — Annual maintenance by qualified party required. Retain all records. Photocopy this page for each location.

Appendix B

OSHA 300A Annual Summary — Posting Calendar & Checklist

Required by 29 CFR 1904.32. Employers with 11 or more employees in covered industries must post the OSHA Form 300A Summary every year from February 1 through April 30 — even if there were zero recordable incidents. The summary must be signed by a company executive.

Month	Action Required	Responsible Party	Completed
January	Review Form 300 log for the prior year. Verify all recordable injuries and illnesses are entered correctly.	_____	■ Done Date: _____
January (by Jan 31)	Complete Form 300A Annual Summary. Total all columns from the Form 300 log. Calculate days away, restricted, transferred.	_____	■ Done Date: _____
January (by Jan 31)	Have a company executive sign and certify the Form 300A. Signature must be an owner, officer, or highest-ranking official.	_____	■ Done Date: _____
February 1	POST Form 300A in a conspicuous location accessible to all employees. Note the posting location below.	_____	■ Done Date: _____
Feb 1– Apr 30	Verify Form 300A remains posted throughout the window. Do not remove early. Check monthly.	_____	■ Verified ■ Verified ■ Verified
May 1	Remove Form 300A from posting. Retain the signed copy with your records for five years.	_____	■ Done Date: _____
Year-round	Log each recordable injury/illness on Form 300 within seven calendar days of learning about it.	_____	■ Ongoing
Year-round	Retain Forms 300, 300A, and 301 for five years following the end of the calendar year they cover.	_____	■ Ongoing

Posting Location Record

Form 300A posted at:	_____
Posted by (name):	_____
Date posted:	_____ Date removed: _____
Executive signature obtained from:	_____

Note: NC employers are subject to NC DOL OSH Division enforcement. Ensure you are using the current OSHA 300, 300A, and 301 forms. Download current forms at osha.gov/recordkeeping.

Before OSHA Shows Up

Your Next Step

If you read this manual and recognized your operation in any of these findings, that recognition is the first step. The second step is doing something about it before someone else forces your hand.

An OSHA inspection is not scheduled. A recordable injury does not wait for a convenient time. The citations in this manual carry penalties starting at \$16,131 per violation — and inspectors do not walk a floor looking for one thing. They walk the whole floor.

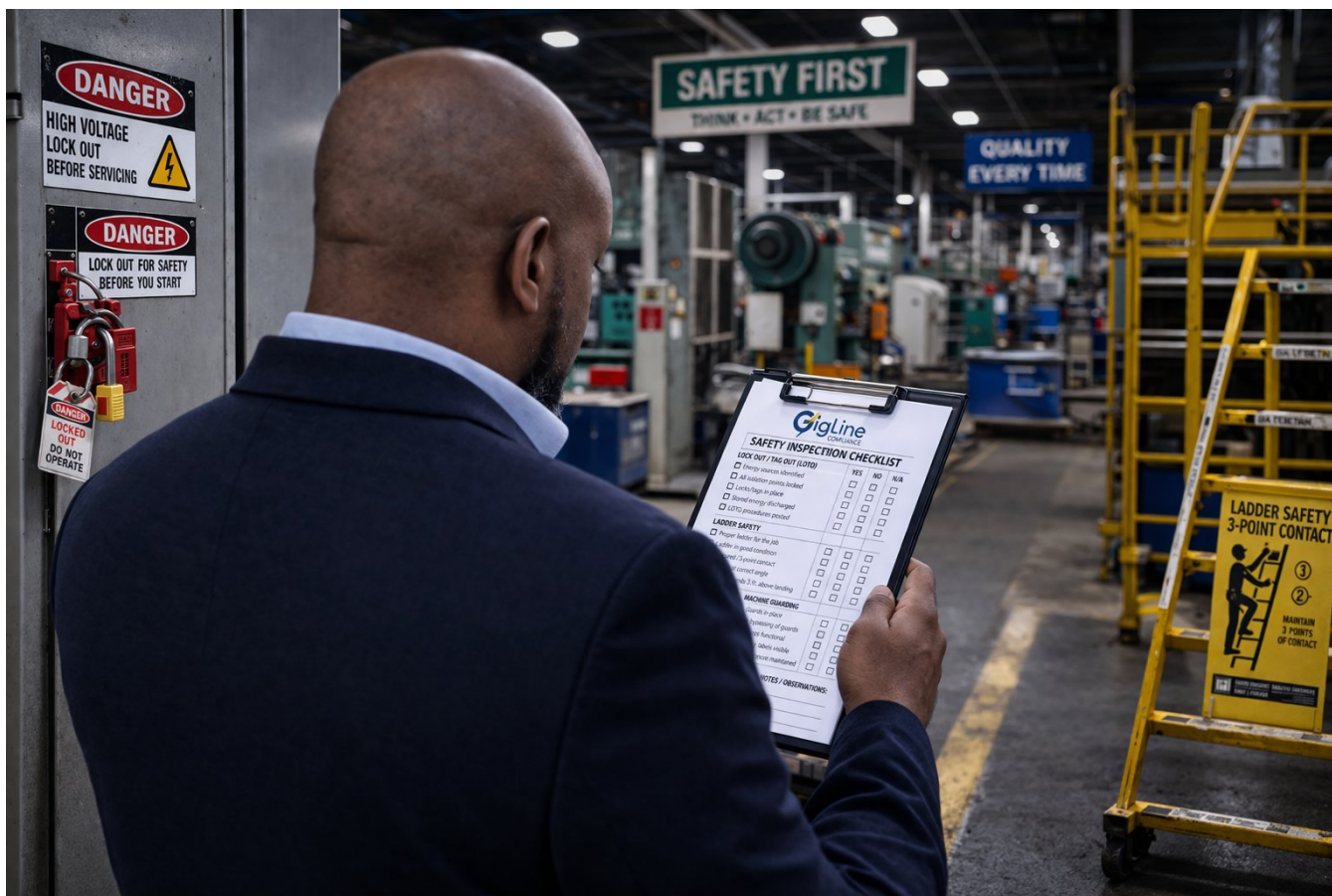
A GigLine Safety Walkthrough gives you a documented picture of where you stand before anyone else is looking. One visit. A written report. A ranked list of what to fix first — RED, AMBER, GREEN. Delivered within 24–48 hours.

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About the Author

**U.S. Navy
Veteran**

**OSHA 30-Hour
Window Industry**

**OSHA 30-Hour
Rubber Industry**

**25+ Years
Industry Experience**

Vince Lawrence — GigLine Safety & Compliance

I spent 25 years inside the kinds of operations I now walk as a consultant — manufacturing facilities, rubber and window production lines, warehouses, and fleet operations. I have worked alongside the people running the equipment, managed the paperwork that holds up under an inspection, and seen what happens when neither is in place.

I hold OSHA 30-Hour certifications in two specific industries — window manufacturing and rubber production — which means my training is not generic. It is mapped to the environments I actually work in. I served in the United States Navy from 1992 to 1998, which is where I first learned that

systems either hold under pressure or they do not, and that the difference is almost always in the preparation.

What I Look For on Your Floor

When I walk a facility, I am not looking to run up a citation count. I am looking for the things that will hurt someone or cost someone money. Those two categories overlap more than most owners realize.

I start at the entry point and work through the operation systematically — machine guarding, energy control, walking surfaces, housekeeping, PPE compliance, posted documentation, and recordkeeping. I talk to the people doing the work, not just the person managing the facility. The floor always tells a different story than the binder.

By the end of the visit, you have a photo-documented report with every finding ranked RED, AMBER, or GREEN — what needs to stop immediately, what needs to be scheduled, and what is in reasonable shape. No ambiguity. No recommendations that require a follow-up engagement to interpret.

Why I Publish This Manual Every Year

Small manufacturers and warehouses in the Piedmont Triad do not have a compliance department. They do not have a dedicated EHS manager. The owner is also the safety officer, the HR department, and the person answering the phone when a customer calls. Compliance gets handled in the margins.

OSHA does not adjust its standards for the size of the operation. The same CFR citations apply to a 12-person fabrication shop and a 1,200-person plant. The penalty structure does not have a small-business discount. What changes is the awareness — and that is what this manual is designed to close.

I publish the 2026 edition because the penalty figures change, the enforcement priorities shift, and the operations I walk every year show me which gaps are showing up most consistently. This is not a generic OSHA summary. It is a field report from the Triad, updated annually, written for the owner who needs to know what to look for before someone else comes looking.

Vince Lawrence

GigLine Safety & Compliance
Kernersville, North Carolina

(336) 329-8899

vince@giglinecompliance.com
giglinecompliance.com

Services

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